

Credit: Apple



Apple MacBook M1

Desktop instead of a laptop is repairability. Laptops and tablets, just like a lot of smartphones out there, aren't easily repairable, let alone upgradeable. But thanks to some clever engineering and innovation, I think this can change over the course of the next decade or two. Being able to hot-swap storage and a couple of other components without having to go through the tedious process of dismantling everything. The same goes for repairability as they go hand-in-hand. Considering how these machines are way more powerful than what an average consumer needs them to be, this could be a nice addition to the scoring sheet as a benchmark. Fingers crossed for this one, in particular.

Pushing the boundaries with new form-factors

There are two laptops sitting in front of me as I write this article. Both of them have completely different form factors. While one of them has two screens to offer more screen real-estate, the other one is a prototype of a foldable laptop. Yes, a laptop with a foldable display. Unique and compelling machines like Microsoft's Surface Neo and Lenovo's ThinkPad X1 Fold give me hope for a better



Lenovo ThinkPad X1 Fold

future for laptops. Using them right now might now inspire confidence but their whole purpose is to show what the future holds for us.

What About Gaming Laptops?

Gaming laptops are arguably one of the most popular categories when it comes to laptops, and rightfully so. Being able to play games on a laptop on-the-go? But where do we go from here? First thing we can expect someone to bring out is a laptop with a widescreen viewing experience. It's been a tough nut to crack, but it's not entirely out of the question, especially when you consider the timeframe and the tech that's available to us.

Some of you may remember Razer's Project Valerie, a monstrosity with three displays. Why does that even exist? Well for Razer and a few hardcore gamers, the right question to ask was, why the hell not? Gamers do envy more pixels for a widescreen viewing experience. As much as we love what OEMs like ASUS are already doing with dual-screen laptops like the ZenBook Pro Duo, I am sure many will go head over heels for more displays. I have little to no doubt in my mind that the future technology will enable OEMs to make today's renders/concepts a reality very soon.

I would also like to touch base with the idea of bringing a water cooling solution to laptops. It sounds like an absurdly far fetched idea, but I'd like to remind you that it's not something that's unheard of. ASUS

tried its hand at making it work with the GX700 back in 2015. It was essentially an external unit that connected to the laptop separately, but it still looked very convincing. It's a shame that it never took off in any way, but perhaps ASUS is saving its best card for later? After all, they are already toying with the idea of using external accessories to enhance the experience, then why not this?

CONCLUSION

Honestly, there's a lot left to be desired when it comes to the future of laptops. But as much as we fill our minds with lucrative ideas, only time will tell exactly how these machines will turn to take their best shape and solve some of the biggest perceived problems with the category as a whole. Maybe none of what I men-



Project Valerie - Razer

tioned above will turn the tide, and there's something significantly better on the horizon. "Expect the unexpected" is not the cliché I was hoping to end with, but that seems to be a general impression, which I am sure my colleagues dealing with other categories will also agree with.

Rest assured, Digit will continue to remain at the forefront leaving no stones unturned to help you get the most value out of your purchase. Our testing methods have also changed overtime to tackle the ever-evolving technologies in the laptop category, but we will continue to innovate in this space and back our claims with objective testing to tell you if the next big laptop release is indeed as good as they make it sound or if it's a laptop of your nightmarish dreams. Either way, there's a lot more to come in the future, we are just as excited as you are. Cheers to the next 20 years and beyond! 🍀